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TRANSPORTATION



Lucid Air owners will soon be able to use Tesla Superchargers — but there's a catch

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Owners of the Lucid Air sedan will be able to charge their luxury EVs at thousands of Tesla Supercharger stations in North America starting July 31, nearly two years since the automakers reached an agreement to make the accessible network available to Lucid Air

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However, the Air will only be able to charge at 50 kW, a far lower rate than the 250 kW peak rate that these Superchargers provide. The issue stems from a mismatch between Lucid's 924-volt charging system and the 400V Tesla Superchargers. Lucid, and any other EV with 800-volt charging systems, simply can't charge as fast as they might with chargers designed for them, as [Consumer Reports](#) notes.

Lucid spokesperson Andrew Hussey explained that engineers repurposed hardware in the Air's

integrated charging system, called Wunderbox, to make the system work and activate 50kW boost charging when using a Supercharger. He added that Lucid views the 50kW charging for Air as another option for owners who are on road trips, or live or work closer to Superchargers.

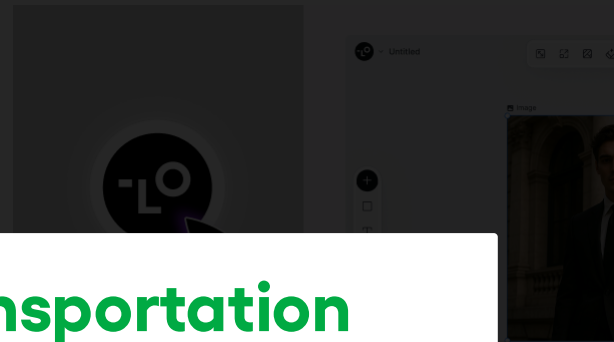
Unlike the Lucid Gravity SUV, which launched earlier this year, the Air is still built with the Combined Charging System (CCS). The CCS was considered the go-to EV charging standard in North America and used by all automakers, with one notable exception. Tesla developed its own charging standard, which includes the built-in charging port on the vehicle as well as an EV charging station. Tesla encourages owners to adopt the standard.

Tesla can't charge its own cars at Superchargers. Charging stations became a key part of the deal with Tesla. The Supercharger network would be built into its vehicles. Ford — including GM, Rivian, Honda, Mercedes, Hyundai, Kia, and Toyota — also agreed that its future EVs would have the NACS charging port built into its vehicles.

Lucid was among the last companies to [strike a deal with Tesla](#). And like the others, Lucid announced that its next EV, the Gravity SUV, would have a built-in NACS charging port.

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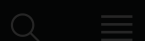
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Lucid Gravity SUV owners will gain access to Tesla Superchargers on January 31

Rebecca Bellan — 6:00 AM PST · January 28, 2025

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Tesla has been opening access to its charging network to non-Tesla EVs in stages as automakers update their EV software and Tesla updates its chargers, which likely explains the gap between [Lucid's initial Gravity deliveries](#) to employees, friends, and family in early December and when owners can access the chargers.

The luxury EV startup also said it would provide adapters to Gravity owners so they can access charging stations with CCS plugs.

Emad Dlala, Lucid's VP of powertrain, said in a statement that the automaker developed a new high-performance 926V powertrain to enable the Gravity 1000V to charge at 350kW. Other features include thermal management and a 100-mile range.

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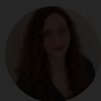
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Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch, where she covers Tesla and Elon Musk's broader empire,...

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Lucid adopts Tesla's charging standard

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Lucid has reached an agreement that will give owners of its luxury EVs access to Tesla's network of superchargers — following the path of Ford, GM and the majority of automakers that sell EVs in North America have taken in recent months.

Ford kicked off the trend [in May 2023](#) when it announced its EV owners would soon have access to about 12,000 Tesla chargers initially via an adapter; Ford added that its next generation of EVs would be integrated with Tesla's charge port called the [North American Charging Standard](#) (NACS) starting in 2025. [GM](#), Rivian, Honda, [Mercedes](#), Hyundai, Kia, Toyota and most recently [Subaru](#)

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followed with their own announcements to adopt Tesla's charging standard.

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Lucid was one of the last remaining holdouts. Like previous announcements, Lucid will begin by providing owners of its EVs, which are built with the Combined Charging System (CCS), with an adapter that will give it access to thousands of Tesla chargers, known as Superchargers. Lucid will incorporate Tesla's NACS charging port into its EVs starting in 2025.

"Adopting NACS is an important next step to providing our customers with expanded access to reliable and convenient charging solutions for their

Lucid vehicles. At Lucid, we're committed to standardizing the future of electric vehicles. It will be a critical step to ensure consumer

Lucid's vehicles. At least for now, the 800-volt electric system's thermal range and

Most electric vehicles — with the exception of the Audi E-Tron GT, Porsche Taycan, Kia EV6 and Hyundai Ioniq 5 — have a 400-volt architecture. For EVs with 800-volt electric systems to reap the full benefits of fast charging times, it needs proper charging equipment that can take advantage of that architecture. Most public chargers have 400-volt systems and today's Tesla Superchargers are rated at about 500 volts. This means that Lucid, and any other EV with 800-volt charging systems, won't be able to charge as fast as they might with chargers designed for them, as [Consumer Reports](#) noted last month.

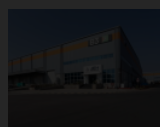
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For now, this is a small point, considering how rare 800-volt fast chargers are out in the world.



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Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous...

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